

HTML5Rocks

HTML5Rocks.com is a website being promoted by Google which will have nine HTML5 tutorials and a code playground section for developers

Google CL

Google has announced a new set of command-line tools named Google CL which will allow you to use Google's popular services from your Linux terminal



A FOSS class in progress

formal syllabus opening new horizons for students to acquire FOSS awareness. Various universities including Anna University Chennai and Rajasthan University have introduced FOSS courses as electives. Anna University, Coimbatore has introduced a FOSS Core Course and Loyola College, Chennai has a FOSS Elective Cluster that includes courses such as Introduction to FOSS, Enterprise Application Development using FOSS and Web Programming using FOSS. NRCFOSS is also looking into development of a FOSS-based CSE Degree Program.

To realise the goal of developing a trained human resource in FOSS, NRCFOSS has introduced various competency certification programs that are open to interested people without necessarily having to enroll in a university or college. Such candidates can take the exam conducted by NRCFOSS and after clearing it they get a certificate from the body stating their level of FOSS competence.

NRCFOSS also conducts FOSS workshops and seminars throughout the country to increase the awareness of FOSS among Indian people. NRCFOSS is also working on "Open Source Maturity Models" that exist for FOSS products and are widely used to evaluate the suitability of a FOSS product for an organisation's use.

Institute for Open Technology and applications Student initiatives The LUG @ IIT Madras



LUGs are active in IIT Madras...

The IIT guys are in no way less active when compared to any other open source community. The Linux User Groups (known as LUG) has a decent history. Mr. Prabhu Ramachandran (author of Maya Vi and a SciPi contributor) started LUG at IIT

Madras in 1997. Since then, LUG has been in an active state. Most of their activities take place online where members help out each other and other interested ones who joined their online community at linuxusers-iitm@googlegroups.com. The LUG members meet at regular intervals throughout the year and hold regular talks on topics ranging from introductory sessions for freshers to detailed topics such as using GNU plot or SciPy. Additional events include sessions over Linux kernel's internals.

When we contacted the current president of LUG @ IIT Madras, he said that recently members of LUG in collaboration with Team Shaastra (the annual techfest of IIT-M) initiated "Shaastra Distro", a project to create a Debian-based distribution.

This project will feature applications written by freshers of IIT Madras, under the guidance of their seniors that would make usability of Linux terminals easier. This distribution would encourage the usage of Linux in rural areas. The LUG members have made decent contributions in several open source projects including KDE, GNOME, OpenEmbedded, git, Minix, ZSH, Scipy and Debian.

Creative initiatives

When we asked them to note some creative initiatives that the LUG at IITM started, the immediate answer was "Hackfest", event conducted as a part of Shaastra. It aims at taking the participants into the world of development, teaching them to help open source grow by giving back something to it. The event is conducted by experienced student contributors from various technical institutions for over 2-3 nights. For many participants this is an eye opening introduction to real life coding. Initiating students with concepts such as IRC, version control, build systems, bug trackers and large-scale software design, this event aims at teaching the participants how they can contribute to the open source community (hopefully by getting a bug patch from them by the end of the event itself).

The LUG @ IIT Delhi

"LUG@IITD is an initiative of the students of IIT Delhi to promote the use of GNU/Linux among its students and staff" is the simple one line introduction the members give. But their activities prove LUG @ IITD is much more than what they define.

Workshops

Since its establishment in 2008, LUG @ IIT-D organized various workshops and seminars.

Starting with a workshop on the basics of Linux, kernel programming and installation of few popular distros, the next workshops covered conceptual topics such as Fortran Programming on Linux, Advanced C pro-



...and IIT Delhi as well